



New Google Glass?

New patent filings point to a revised version of the Google Glass
<http://dgit.in/GogIGlass>



LinkedIn apps redesigned

LinkedIn redesigns its mobile apps, which are now available for download from the app stores for Android and iOS <http://dgit.in/LinkedInReD>



DESIGN

MICROMAX LAPBOOK

The Lapbook looks quite pedestrian, which many may not like. It weighs 1.3kg, which may be a tad heavy for some, but its small size makes the device quite easy to carry about. Considering the fact that none of its competitors are much lighter, we don't quite hold the weight against this device.

The laptop is built sturdily, with no creaks anywhere. But the plastic body feels much less premium than most others present in the lineup.

XOLO CHROMEBOOK

As a budget product, the matte plastic on this laptop looks quite good, but raise the lid and you see a glossy plastic panel around the keyboard, which is prone to both smudges and dust. The glossy plastic inside is really a downer.

The XOLO Chromebook's keyboard though is not meant for long term usage. In our unit, the keys make that creaking sound often and hamper the typing experience. The keys are also wobbly.

ACER ASPIRE ES1-131

This device carries a really old school design, which some may like, but it looks dated today. It's also thicker than the other three laptops in this comparison. This in turn makes the device feel bulkier, even though it weighs 1.2kg, pretty much the same as the XOLO Chromebook (1.5 kg) and the Micromax Canvas Lapbook.

The use of plastic also continues here and the ES1 actually feels somewhat like the XOLO device.

ASUS EEEBOOK E402MA

Amongst the laptops in this comparison, the E402MA is by far the best looking and best designed of the lot. So much so that we don't mind the bigger size and footprint. Of course, the fact that the device has a 14 inch display plays a big role in that.

The E402M though makes the right use of plastic. It's slightly heavy, but its metallic finish makes the laptop look much more premium than any of its competitors. Its full-sized keyboard aids typing.

VERDICT

The ASUS EeeBook E402MA is the undeniable *Best Performer* of this bunch, while the Xolo Chromebook bags the *Best*

Buy Award. Having said that, while our tests do show that the Asus E402MA is the best performer amongst the lap-

tops that we tested, the answer to the question we asked at the beginning remains. Does it make sense to spend on

these laptops or would you make a better investment buying a slightly more expensive laptop with more features and better performance?

The ASUS E402MA, which is the best performer in this test, still lags in the face of traditional laptops. All of the laptops in the test feel like devices that were meant to be tablets, but have been modified to meet user demands. Yes, your parents, who perhaps only use the laptop for browsing online, will find these useful, but for most of us, it makes more sense to invest in a slightly more expensive laptop, that lasts longer and performs much better. **d**



ASUS E402MA

PROS:

- Good performance
- Good looks and build
- Cloud backup
- Screen quality
- Keyboard and touchpad

CONS:

- Large size



XOLO CHROMEBOOK

PROS:

- Battery life
- Built-in Google services
- Cloud backup
- Inexpensive

CONS:

- Restrictive OS
- Not enough apps



ACER ASPIRE ES1

PROS:

- USB 3.0, features
- Lightweight
- Fast-paced, large hard drive
- Cloud backup

CONS:

- Battery life
- Look and feel